

Lumina — Business Overview

Audience: Business, marketing, and operations reviewers

Stage: Private Beta / Production Testing

Website: [joinlumina.co] (<https://joinlumina.co>)

I. What Lumina Is

Lumina is a beauty marketplace that helps clients discover and evaluate independent beauty professionals with more confidence.

Clients can browse professionals by service and location, compare profiles, review portfolios and pricing, save favorites, send service requests, message professionals, and leave verified reviews after completed appointments.

Beauty professionals can create a public profile, list services and pricing, show their portfolio and availability, respond to requests, communicate with clients, and build a trustworthy reputation through verified reviews.

II. Why Lumina Exists

Finding a beauty professional is often fragmented across social media, search engines, personal referrals, and individual booking links. Important information may be incomplete or difficult to compare, and reviews are not always connected to a real service.

Lumina is designed to make that decision clearer by bringing discovery, comparison, communication, and trust into one experience.

The central belief is:

> Clients should be able to understand who they are trusting before spending money or trusting someone with their appearance.

III. The Problem

For clients

- Portfolios, prices, locations, and availability are spread across different platforms.
- It can be difficult to compare professionals consistently.
- Social-media popularity does not always equal service quality or reliability.
- Reviews may be anonymous, unverified, or disconnected from a real appointment.
- Contacting several professionals can become confusing and time-consuming.

For beauty professionals

- Independent professionals often depend heavily on social platforms they do not control.
- Strong work can be difficult to discover without a large following.
- Profiles, booking links, messages, and reviews are fragmented.
- Newer professionals need a credible way to build trust.
- Professionals need qualified client interest, not only views or followers.

IV. How Lumina Works

1. A client discovers professionals through search, categories, browse, or map view.
2. The client compares profiles, services, prices, portfolios, availability, and reviews.
3. The client sends a service request to a chosen professional.

4. The professional replies with a proposal or appointment details.
5. The client confirms the appointment and both parties can communicate through request-linked messaging.
6. After the service, the assigned professional marks the appointment complete.
7. Only the authenticated client connected to that completed appointment can leave a verified review.
8. The professional may publicly respond to the review.

V. What Makes Lumina Different

Lumina is not intended to be only another directory or booking link.

Its main differentiator is the trust lifecycle:

****Discovery → Request → Confirmation → Service Completion → Verified Review****

The review system is protected at the database level:

- A review requires a completed appointment.
- Only the authenticated client associated with the request can review it.
- Only one review is permitted per completed appointment.
- Anonymous fake-review insertion is blocked.
- Professionals can respond, but cannot create client reviews for themselves.

VI. Current Product

Lumina currently includes:

- Client and professional accounts
- Public professional profiles
- Services, pricing, portfolios, location, and availability
- Homepage search, Browse, and Map discovery
- Category filters and sorting
- Saved professionals and comparison
- Service requests and proposals
- Client confirmation and professional completion
- Realtime messaging, unread states, and notifications
- Verified reviews and professional responses
- Client and professional request archiving
- Account settings and secure password recovery
- Responsive mobile and desktop experiences

VII. Current Market Approach

Lumina is entering a focused private beta rather than attempting a broad public launch immediately.

The initial supply target is five high-quality, active beauty professionals. The purpose is to observe whether professionals understand the value, complete their profiles, respond to requests, return to the platform, and identify real onboarding friction.

The private beta should measure:

- Outreach sent
- Professional responses
- Interested professionals
- Accounts created
- Profiles completed
- Requests received
- Returning professionals
- Repeated feedback and friction

VIII. Initial Target Users

Supply side

- Independent beauty professionals
- Salon-based professionals building their own clientele
- Mobile beauty professionals
- Newer professionals with strong work but limited online reach
- Professionals who want a clearer public profile and trustworthy reviews

Demand side

- Clients searching for a new beauty professional
- Clients comparing price, location, specialty, and style
- Clients who value verified experiences and visual portfolios
- Clients who want a clearer way to request and track appointments

IX. Business Questions to Validate

Lumina is not assuming the final business model is already known. The beta should help answer:

1. Is the trust and verified-review system valuable enough to change client behavior?
2. Will professionals complete and maintain a profile without significant assistance?
3. Does Lumina generate useful client inquiries rather than low-intent traffic?
4. Which professional segment feels the strongest need for Lumina?
5. What part of the product creates repeat use?
6. Which future monetization model feels fair to both sides?

Possible future models may include professional subscriptions, premium profile tools, qualified-lead fees, promoted discovery, or booking-related services. These should be tested only after meaningful demand is demonstrated.

X. Current Priorities

1. Complete production end-to-end testing.
2. Recruit the first private-beta professionals.
3. Observe onboarding without immediately intervening.
4. Record bugs, UX friction, feature requests, and founder observations separately.
5. Prioritize repeated feedback rather than changing the product for every opinion.
6. Validate client demand and professional retention.

XI. Feedback Requested From Business Reviewers

When reviewing Lumina, please consider:

- Is the value proposition immediately understandable?
- Which audience should Lumina target first?
- What would motivate a professional to join and maintain a profile?
- What would make a client trust Lumina enough to send a request?
- Does the current messaging communicate trust without overpromising?
- What is the most realistic early customer-acquisition approach?
- Which partnerships could help the private beta?
- Which business assumptions appear weak or untested?
- What should Lumina deliberately avoid doing too early?

XII. One-Sentence Summary

Lumina helps clients find beauty professionals they can trust and helps independent professionals turn their work, service history, and verified client experiences into a credible online reputation.